DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT REPORT

Course: Digital Literacy (CSE0001)

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Introduction

This project, undertaken as part of the Digital Literacy course (CSE0001), is designed to develop essential digital skills required in modern education and professional environments. Digital literacy is no longer optional - it is a core competency for students entering technology-driven fields. The project is structured across five tasks, each targeting a distinct area of digital skill: visual communication using Canva, building a professional online presence on GitHub and Linkedin, practising coding on HackerRank, developing email etiquette, and raising awareness about cybercrime and phishing. Through these hands-on activities, the project bridges the gap between theoretical knowledge and practical application, helping students develop technical skills, responsible online behaviour, and professional communication abilities. This report documents my experiences and key learnings from each task.

Task 1 – Infographic Write-up

For Task 1, I created a digital literacy awareness infographic using Canva. The infographic was designed to explain the concept of digital literacy and its importance for students. It covered topics such as safe internet practices, useful digital tools, and maintaining a professional online presence. I used simple icons, clear headings, and minimal text to make the design visually appealing and easy to understand.

The main aim of the infographic was to educate students about how to use digital platforms responsibly and effectively. I included examples like using strong passwords, avoiding suspicious links, and using platforms like GitHub and LinkedIn for career development.

While creating the infographic, I found it interesting to explore Canva's design features such as templates, colour combinations, and layout tools. One challenge I faced was selecting the right amount of content so that the infographic was not overcrowded but still informative. Overall, this task improved my creativity and helped me understand how to communicate important information visually.

Task 2 – Digital Portfolio Write-up

In Task 2, I created and updated my professional digital profiles on platforms such as GitHub, LinkedIn, and Stack Overflow. These platforms are widely used by students and professionals to showcase skills, connect with others, and learn new concepts.

On GitHub, I created a repository and added a profile README that includes my name, branch, and academic details. GitHub is useful for storing and sharing projects. On LinkedIn, I updated my education details, including my degree, institution, and expected graduation year. LinkedIn helps in building a professional network and finding job or internship opportunities. On Stack Overflow, I created a profile to ask questions and learn from programming discussions.

Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub to upload projects, LinkedIn to build connections and explore opportunities, and Stack Overflow to improve my technical knowledge. This task helped me understand the importance of maintaining a professional digital presence.

Task 3 – Platforms Write-up

In Task 3, I explored both coding practice platforms and collaboration tools. I created an account on HackerRank and completed a beginner-level coding challenge. This helped me understand basic problem-solving and improve my logical thinking skills. Platforms like HackerRank are useful for practising coding and preparing for technical interviews.

For the collaboration part, I created a Google Form titled "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz." The form included five questions, such as multiple-choice and short-answer questions, to test students' understanding of digital literacy concepts. I also viewed the responses in Google Sheets, which helped me understand how data is collected and analysed.

This task was very useful as it introduced me to tools that are important for both academic and professional use. Coding platforms help improve technical skills, while tools like Google Forms are useful for surveys, quizzes, and data collection.

Overall, this task enhanced my practical knowledge and confidence in using online tools.

Task 4 – Email Etiquette Write-up

In this task, I learned how to write professional emails and follow proper email etiquette. I created two emails: one requesting an assignment deadline extension and another expressing interest in a summer internship. I focused on using a clear subject line, formal greeting, polite tone, and proper closing.

Poor digital communication can lead to misunderstandings and missed opportunities. For example, sending an email without a subject line or using informal language can create a negative impression. In professional settings, communication should always be clear, respectful, and structured.

This task helped me understand how important email etiquette is in academic and professional environments. I learned to keep emails concise, polite, and well-organised. These skills will be very useful when communicating with professors, employers, and colleagues in the future.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Write-up

For Task 5, I explored cybercrime awareness, focusing on topics such as phishing and online fraud. I learned how cybercriminals use fake emails, messages, or websites to trick users into sharing personal or financial information. This research helped me understand how common these attacks are and how easily people can become victims.

One thing that surprised me was how realistic phishing messages can look, making it difficult to identify them. It made me realise the importance of being cautious while using digital platforms.

As a result of this task, I will be more careful while clicking links, sharing personal information, and making online payments. I will also ensure that I use strong passwords and enable security features like two-factor authentication. This task increased my awareness of online safety and responsible digital behaviour.

Conclusion

This Digital Literacy Project provided me with valuable knowledge and practical experience in using digital tools effectively and responsibly. I learned how to create visual content, build a professional online presence, practise coding, communicate professionally, and stay safe online. Each task contributed to improving my technical skills, communication abilities, and awareness of digital risks. The project also helped me understand the importance of maintaining a positive digital footprint. Overall, this experience has prepared me to use digital technologies more confidently and responsibly in my academic and professional journey.

References

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5. HackerRank – https://www.hackerrank.com

6. Google Forms / Google Sheets – https://workspace.google.com